Translations

H 2220

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A. Background

The heading ***Translations*** and the subdivisions ***--Translations*** and ***--Translations into [name of language]*** are assigned to collections of translations or to works about translations. Use of the subdivisions ***Translations from [name of language]***, ***Translations from foreign languages***, ***Translations into foreign languages***, and ***Translations, [name of language]*** was discontinued in 1991. For specific instructions on translations of the Bible and other sacred works, see H 1300. For works on the technique of translating, see H 2219.

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

B. Recent revisions

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Translation: an act, process, or instance of translating, such as a rendering from one language into another[1]; in general, translation applies to written texts and interpretation applies to oral communication

D. Literary translations

D.1. Literary form headings

Assign the free-floating subdivisions ***Translations*** and ***Translations into [name of language]*** under literary form headings for collections of translated works and translations of individual works in a specific form that have been assigned a literary form heading. For works translated into one language assign the subdivision ***--Translations into [name of language]***, for example, ***--Translations into French***. For works translated into several languages assign the subdivision ***--Translations***. For works about translations assign the further subdivision ***--History and criticism*** or other subdivision as appropriate.

LC practice: Assign subject headings to the topical focus of the work, if applicable. Also assign one to bring out ethnicity and/or nationality, if appropriate. Bring out the language of a translation through other elements of descriptive cataloging. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Translations*** and ***Poetry***.

Example:

Title: Contemporary Portuguese poetry : an anthology in English.

650 #0 $a Portuguese poetry $y 20th century $v Translations into English.

LC practice:

041 1# $a eng $h por

650 #0 $a Portuguese poetry $y 20th century.

655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Poetry $2 lcgft

Title: Translation as discovery and other essays on Indian literature in English translation.

650 #0 $a Indic literature $x Translations into English $x History and criticism.

LC practice:

041 1# $a eng $h inc

[1] TRANSLATION Definition & Meaning - Merriam-Webster

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650 #0 $a Indic literature $x Translations into English $x History and
       criticism.
655 #7 $a Literary criticism $2 lcgft
```

Title: Aeneis. English

```
600 00 $a Aeneis $c (Legendary character) $v Poetry.
650 #0 $a Epic poetry, Latin $v Translations into English.
```

LC practice:

```
041 1# $a eng $h lat
600 00 $a Aeneis $c (Legendary character)
655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Epic poetry $2 lcgft
```

Title: Estonian literature in foreign languages : a bibliography.

```
650 #0 $a Estonian literature $x Translations $v Bibliography.
```

LC practice:

```
041 1# $a eng $h est
650 #0 $a Estonian literature $x Translations.
655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft
```

D.2. Individual literary authors and works

Assign the free-floating subdivisions ***--Translations*** and ***--Translations into [name of language]*** under names of individual literary authors or literary works entered under title for collections of translations. Do not assign these subdivisions under author-title subject headings. Do not assign these subdivisions under authors or uniform titles for single translations of one work. For works about translations assign the further subdivision ***--History and criticism*** or other subdivision as appropriate.

LC practice: Assign subject headings to the topical focus of the work, if applicable. Also assign one to bring out ethnicity and/or nationality, if appropriate. Bring out the language of a translation through other elements of descriptive cataloging. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Translations*** and ***Poetry***.

Example:

Title: Catullus : the complete poems for American readers.

```
600 10 $a Catullus, Gaius Valerius $v Translations into English.
```

LC practice:

```
041 1# $a eng $h lat
655 #7 $a Poetry. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft
```

Title: Poe in foreign lands and tongues.

```
600 10 $a Poe, Edgar Allan, $d 1809-1849 $x Translations $x History and
       criticism.
```

LC practice:

```
600 10 $a Poe, Edgar Allan, $d 1809-1849 $x Translations $x History and
       criticism.
655 #7 $a Essays. $2 lcgft
```

Title: The German versions of Chekhov's Three sisters : a study in the theory and practice of translation.

```
600 10 $a Chekhov, Anton Pavlovich, $d 1860-1904. $t Trisestry.
600 10 $a Chekhov, Anton Pavlovich, $d 1860-1904 $x Translations into German
       $x History and criticism.
650 #0 $a Translating and interpreting.
```

E. Non-literary translations

LC practice: Assign subject headings to the topical focus of the work, if applicable. Also assign one to bring out ethnicity and/or nationality, if appropriate. Bring out the language of a translation through other elements of descriptive cataloging. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Translations*** and ***Poetry***.

E.1. General works

Assign the heading ***Translations*** to works on translations from several languages not limited to a subject or form. For works on translations from one language assign the heading ***[name of language] imprints*** with free-floating subdivision ***--Translations*** or ***--Translations into [name of language]*** and further subdivisions as appropriate.

Example:

Title: Index translationum. International bibliography of translations.

```
650 #0 $a Translations $v Bibliography.
```

LC practice:

```
650 #0 $a Translations.
655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft
```

Title: Traduzioni dall'italiano nella Biblioteca del Congresso di Washington, 1977-1981.

650 #0 $a Italian imprints $x Translations into English $v Catalogs.

610 20 $a Library of Congress $v Catalogs.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Italian imprints $x Translations into English.

610 20 $a Library of Congress.

655 #7 $a Library catalogs $2 lcgft

E.2. Specific subjects or forms

Assign the free-floating subdivisions ***--Translations*** and ***--Translations into [name of language]*** under topical headings and under headings for types or forms of published materials for collections of translated works. For works translated into one language assign the subdivision ***--Translations into [name of language]***, for example, ***--Translations into French***. For works translated into several languages assign the subdivision ***--Translations***. For works about translations, assign the further subdivision ***--History and criticism*** or other subdivision as appropriate.

Note: Assign these subdivisions under topical headings only if the primary purpose of the work is to provide translated materials and this purpose is stated or implied by the title. Do not assign these subdivisions to works by one author or to translations of individual works (including individual periodicals). For special instructions on folklore genre headings and music headings see H 1627, sec. 3.a. and H 1917.

Example:

Title: English language equivalent editions of foreign language serials.

650 #0 $a Periodicals $x Translations into English $v Bibliography.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Periodicals $x Translations into English.

655 #7 $a Bibliographies. $2 lcgft

Title: Selected translations in mathematical statistics and probability.

650 #0 $a Mathematical statistics $v Translations into English.

650 #0 $a Probabilities $v Translations into English.

LC practice:

041 1# $a eng $h mul

650 #0 $a Mathematical statistics.

650 #0 $a Probabilities.

655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft

F. Extended examples

Title: Ouroboros review.

650 #0 $a Poetry $x Translations $v Periodicals.

650 #0 $a Translations $v Periodicals.

LC practice:

041 1# $a eng $h mul

655 #7 $a Poetry. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Periodicals. $2 lcgft

Title: The fairy tales of Hans Christian Andersen and Charles Perrault.

650 #0 $a Fairy tales $z Denmark.

650 #0 $a Children's stories, Danish $v Translations into English.

650 #0 $a Fairy tales $z France.

650 #0 $a Children's stories, French $v Translations into English.

LC practice:

041 1# $a eng $h dan $h fre

385 ## $a Children #2 lcdgt

650 #0 $a Fairy tales $z Denmark.

650 #0 $a Children's stories, Danish.

650 #0 $a Fairy tales $z France.

650 #0 $a Children's stories, French.

655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Fairy tales. $2 lcgft

Title: The Columbia anthology of traditional Chinese literature.

650 #0 $a Chinese literature $v Translations into English.

LC practice:

041 1# $a eng $h chi

650 #0 $a Chinese literature.

```
655 #7 $a Translations. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Anthologies $2 lcgft
```

Revision history

2026-01: Updated template. Added instructions related to LCGFT implementation.